

Process of Constructing a Persona

Personas are fictional yet research-based representations of target users. They are built to reflect patterns in users' behaviors, motivations, and goals so that design decisions are anchored in real user needs rather than assumptions.

The persona creation process can be broken down into **seven systematic steps**:

1. Identify Behavioral Variables

Purpose:

Behavioral variables are dimensions along which user behaviors differ significantly. These might relate to **frequency of use, attitude toward technology, decision-making process, communication style, or skill level**.

How to do it:

- Review collected qualitative data (e.g., interviews, field studies, observations).
- Look for recurring behaviors, actions, or choices.
- Group them into meaningful dimensions (e.g., “frequency of online shopping,” “level of comfort with mobile apps”).

Example:

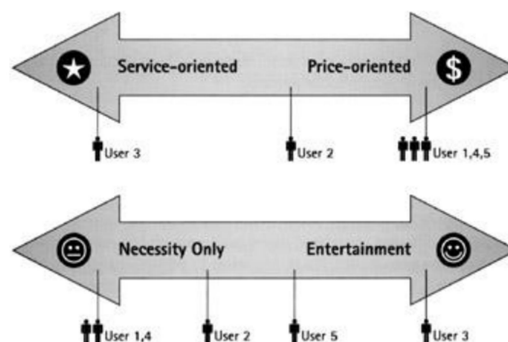
For an **online supermarket mobile app** project:

- Behavioral variables might include:
 - How often they shop for groceries online (daily/weekly/monthly/rarely)
 - Whether they pre-plan their shopping list or shop spontaneously
 - Comfort level with online payment methods
 - Preference for home delivery vs. store pickup

2. Map Interview Subjects to Behavioral Variables

Purpose:

Place each participant along the spectrum of each identified behavioral variable to visualize distribution and patterns.



How to do it:

- Create a matrix or spreadsheet with **rows as participants** and **columns as variables**.
- Use qualitative notes or ratings to mark where each user falls.
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Example:

Participant	Online Shopping Frequency	Payment Comfort	Delivery vs Pickup Preference
P1	Weekly	High	Home Delivery
P2	Monthly	Low	Store Pickup
P3	Daily	High	Home Delivery
P4	Rarely	Medium	Store Pickup

3. Identify Significant Behaviour Patterns

Purpose:

Look for **clusters** or **trends** among the mapped data that show meaningful differences between groups of users.

How to do it:

- Highlight areas where behaviors cluster together (e.g., people who shop daily AND prefer home delivery AND are tech-savvy).
- These clusters indicate potential persona archetypes.

Example:

From the above table:

- **Cluster 1:** Daily/Weekly shoppers + High payment comfort + Home delivery preference
- **Cluster 2:** Monthly/Rare shoppers + Low/Medium payment comfort + Store pickup preference

4. Synthesize Characteristics and Relevant Goals

Purpose:

Translate patterns into persona characteristics and define **what these users are trying to achieve**.

How to do it:

- For each cluster, write key descriptive traits (age range, lifestyle hints, tech comfort, habits).
- State their **primary goals** related to the product/service.

Example:

- **Persona A:** Tech-Savvy Time Saver
 - Characteristics: Works full-time, shops online weekly, values convenience, uses mobile payments.
 - Goals: Save time, avoid store queues, get fast home delivery.
- **Persona B:** Price-Conscious Occasional Shopper
 - Characteristics: Retired, shops monthly, cautious with online payments, prefers in-person pickup.
 - Goals: Save money, avoid delivery fees, maintain control over product quality.

5. Check for Redundancy and Completeness

Purpose:

Ensure that personas are **distinct** from one another and cover the full range of user behaviors without overlaps.

How to do it:

- Compare all personas side-by-side.
- Remove duplicates or merge overly similar ones.
- Make sure each persona represents a significant, real segment.

Example:

If two personas are both “busy professionals shopping online weekly,” combine them into one unless there’s a meaningful difference (e.g., one is a parent cooking at home, the other eats out often).

6. Develop Narratives or Expand Description of Attributes and Behaviors

Purpose:

Make the persona feel like a **real person** by adding stories, motivations, frustrations, and habits. This helps the design team empathize.

How to do it:

- Give a name, photo, age, and background.
- Describe a “day in the life” scenario relevant to your product.
- Include their frustrations, needs, and decision triggers.

Example (Persona A – Tech-Savvy Time Saver):

Priya Sharma, 32, works as a software engineer in Mumbai. She orders groceries twice a week through her smartphone, often during her office coffee break. She prefers UPI payments and values same-day delivery. Priya dislikes navigating crowded supermarkets and uses saved shopping lists in the app to speed up checkout. Her biggest frustration is when fresh produce isn’t available for quick delivery.

7. Designate Persona Types

Once the main persona profiles are created, classify them into **types** based on their importance, influence, and relevance to design decisions. This helps the team **prioritize** who they are designing for and recognize edge cases.

7.1. Primary Personas

Definition:

The main target user group your product must satisfy. Designing for this persona ensures that the largest, most valuable user segment's needs are met.

Example (Online Supermarket App):

- **Priya Sharma, 32, Tech-Savvy Time Saver**
Works full-time, shops online twice a week, prefers home delivery, and values quick checkout.
→ If Priya's needs are met, most other frequent shoppers' needs will also be met.

7.2. Secondary Personas

Definition:

Users whose needs are important but not the primary driver of design. They may require some additional features, but the core design is not centered around them.

Example:

- **Ramesh Patil, 60, Price-Conscious Occasional Shopper**
Shops monthly, prefers in-store pickup, cautious with online payments.
→ Needs basic digital literacy support, but the main app flow is not optimized solely for him.

7.3. Supplemental Personas

Definition:

Personas who may use the product in specific contexts or for occasional tasks, but are not the main focus. They usually require small tweaks or additional modules.

Example:

- **Aarti Deshpande, 25, Fitness Enthusiast**
Uses the supermarket app mainly to buy fresh fruits, vegetables, and organic products once a week.
→ Only certain features like nutritional info or "fresh stock alerts" are relevant to her.

7.4. Customer Personas

Definition:

Represents the **buying decision-maker** who may not be the end user. Important when the person paying is different from the person using the product.

Example:

- **Sunita Rao, 45, Homemaker (Decision-Maker)**
She controls the household budget and decides where groceries are purchased. Her children or spouse may place the orders, but she chooses the app based on price, discounts, and trust.

7.5. Served Personas

Definition:

Indirectly impacted by the product — they may benefit from it but are not actively using it themselves.

Example:

- **Aman Rao, 12, School Student**
Doesn't use the supermarket app, but benefits when his mother orders his favourite snacks and tiffin items online.

7.6. Negative Personas

Definition:

A representation of users **you are not designing for** — people who are outside your target audience. Helps avoid wasting resources and prevents feature creep.

Example:

- **Wholesale Buyer**
Runs a small grocery shop and wants to use the supermarket app for large-scale bulk purchasing. The app is meant for retail customers only, so his needs are excluded from the design.

Clark Andrews

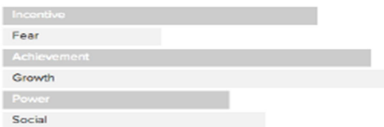
AGE 26
OCCUPATION Software Developer
STATUS Single
LOCATION San Jose, CA
TIER Experiment Hacker
ARCHETYPE The Computer Nerd

Friendly Clever Go-Getter



"I feel like there's a smarter way for me to transition into a healthier lifestyle."

Motivations



Goals

- To cut down on unhealthy eating and drinking habits
- To measure multiple aspects of life more scientifically
- To set goals and see and make positive impacts on his life

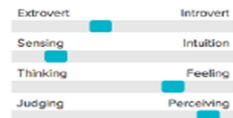
Frustrations

- Unfamiliar with wearable technology
- Saturated tracking market
- Manual tracking is too time consuming

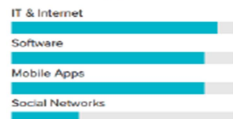
Bio

Aaron is a systems software developer, a "data junkie" and for the past couple years, has been very interested in tracking aspects of his health and performance. Aaron wants to track his mood, happiness, sleep quality and how his eating and exercise habits affects his well being. Although he only drinks occasionally with friends on the weekend, he would like to cut down on alcohol intake.

Personality



Technology



Brands

